

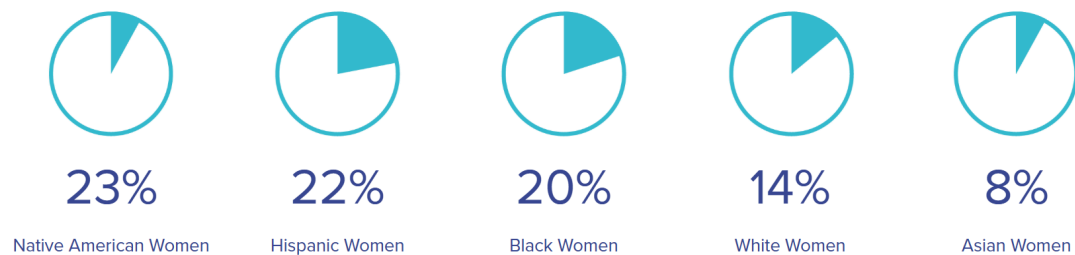
- Women's health inequity in high-risk/low-income areas, how the women in vulnerable communities are being affected the most (menstruation, not enough exposure/support for women, how the data mostly represent men)
- Both as a provider and a caretaker, women are the most vulnerable
- <https://link.springer.com/content/pdf/10.1186/s13690-020-00497-w.pdf>
- In most poor communities, women play dual roles. As providers, they usually work in agriculture or other informal sectors, and they collect food, water, and fuel. As caretakers, they look after the children, the sick, and the elderly; the home; and the family's assets. As a result, women often have invaluable knowledge about adapting to erratic environmental changes. When women are included equally with men in disaster preparedness training, their survival rates improve.
However, socially constructed roles and responsibilities usually put women at a disadvantage in preparing for climate change. Women have less access to resources, are frequently unable to swim or leave the house unattended, and are less likely to migrate to look for shelter and work when a disaster hits. Statistically, women (and children) are more likely to die than men during disasters.
In addition, after the floods, droughts, and storms, women often encounter domestic and sexual violence and are deprived of essential services. Relief efforts regularly shortchange female health needs, such as obstetrical care. Girls drop out of school to save on school fees or to spend more time fetching water. Taken in combination, these circumstances contribute to a cycle where women are unable to participate in decision-making about climate change solutions. (taken from Oxfam)-
<https://s3.amazonaws.com/oxfam-us/www/static/oa3/files/climatechangewomen-factsheet.pdf>
- Poor sanitation takes 1.4 million lives annually, with women and girls bearing a disproportionate burden, according to the World Health Organization. Meanwhile, conditions such as premenstrual syndrome, depression, and gynaecological diseases are among the leading conditions that restrict female contributions to GDP growth.-
https://www.gavi.org/vaccineswork/gender-health-gap-its-more-womens-issue-heres-why?gad_source=1&gad_campaignid=12319817265&gbraid=0AAAAADibICOOFHgLtweSit0VTJ4tln0Rf&gclid=CjwKCAjwtfvEBhAmEiwA-DsKjqQwGdbPI1ub5s73sy-NBL6XtskmawWVOiWzEQNvd4zbA-jTMMZCjBoCV0QQAuD_BwE
- One of the larger issues at play is that prevention for women's health issues has historically been less of a focus than intervention-based services. This was made explicit during the COVID-19 pandemic, as it exacerbated critical disparities and exposed key gaps in healthcare policies and systems.-
<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2023/01/women-health-gap-davos-2023/>
- **Reasons for gender inequalities in health include,** emphasis on women's childbearing roles resulting in early and excessive childbearing; sex preference manifested in discrimination against female children in health and general care; women's workloads

which not only expose them to health hazards but also make it difficult for them to take time off for healthcare; lack of autonomy by women leading to lack of decision-making power and access to independent income; early marriage which exposes women to the complications of early and excessive childbearing.-

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0277953694903565>

Sixteen percent of women report fair or poor health status, according to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC)'s Behavioral Risk Factor Surveillance System (BRFSS).

These percentages are even higher among women of color.



- <https://swhr.org/programs/womens-health-equity-initiative/>
- The health gap relates to the lack of equity concerning healthcare for women and men. This gap can take shape in many ways, from access to care to research. For instance, the women's health gap equates to 75 million years of life lost due to poor health or early death each year. Closing the gap would give the 3.9 billion women in the world today an extra 2.5 healthy days a year, finds a recent report by the World Economic Forum and McKinsey.
This gap has economic consequences as well. In 2020, for example, only 1% of healthcare research and innovation was invested in female-specific conditions beyond oncology, according to the Forum report. However, according to that same research, every \$1 invested in women's health would return around \$3 in economic growth.-
<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/10/women-health-gap-healthcare-gender/>
- A study in August 2024 revealed that [doctors treat men and women differently when it comes to pain](#). Women are 10% less likely than men to have their pain level assessed when they arrive at the hospital, the study found. Women also wait around half an hour longer than men to be seen by a doctor and are less likely to be given pain medication.

Solution/Action plan

- Increasing girls' access to and uptake of STEM careers and education could help address the inequalities.-

<https://www.weforum.org/stories/2024/10/women-health-gap-healthcare-gender/>

- Healthcare should be based on where people are, not just the location of GP clinics. We must make accessible healthcare the norm.
- The “stay at home” order has had an adverse impact on women, whose disproportionate role as home-school teachers and carers has limited their ability to access traditional healthcare.